IC frontier campaign — Phase 0 pilot run report

Run. 2026-10-15, sessions started 04:36–04:52 UTC. Nine `ecbench` sessions; specs `pilot/spec-*.json`; binary SHA-256 in `pilot/ecbench.sha256`. Host: repository cloud container, Linux x86_64, 4 vCPU, 15 GiB; `--cpus none --allow-busy`, so every record is **L0**: operation counts only, no wall time admitted. Protocol: `PROTOCOL.md` (draft, not frozen).

Workloads. Public hash-to-subgroup targets, train seed 20261015100; one or two targets per arm. Curves: Koblitz E_a at $n = 13, 19, 23$; prime: `prime_search` 20-bit, PKM ladder 24/28-bit, `find_a3_curve` 32/36/40-bit.

Requested and completed. 65 executions; 57 verified, 8 exhausted: negfold with full-rank linear algebra at $n = 13$ (2) and both prime IC arms with a fixed 64-point base at 32, 36 and 40 bits (6). No timeouts, errors or crashes. Every record is in `pilot/TABLE.md`.



Figure 1: Charged S per arm and curve, as recorded (single targets; open marker = lower bound, × = exhausted). Sessions ECBS1h8da761a6e558, ECBS1h4e3c36fa57bd, ECBS1h7d1741682d1e, ECBS1h8a85c79c72d0, ECBS1hf28feb0fe98c, ECBS1ha6179c6e7e0d, ECBS1hfda2c8befe2c, ECBS1h94b78342b569, ECBS1hda3b226c750b.

Observations (no comparison is made). Every rho, BSGS and kangaroo record is a lower bound. IC negfold and F4 records are complete at $n = 13$ and $n = 23$ (pinned calibrations) and lower bounds at $n = 19$. `ic-compact` and the prime IC arms leave counters unpriced without emitting their counts. One inherited-F4 execution at $n = 23$ took about 6 minutes (charged $S = 85,071$). Interpretation and protocol consequences: `pilot/FINDINGS.md`.

Raw records. `pilot/sessions/<name>/records.jsonl`; replay audits not run for the pilot.